

What is Unipicks?

And we now have that answer saved in docs/01-product.md.

Our next question — only one

Think about the **student**.

Imagine you are a Kepler student opening Unipicks for the first time.

What do you want that student to feel or think when they see Unipicks?

For example, it could be:

"I can find things here that are cheaper because I'm a student."

But don't use my example if it doesn't feel right.

What do you want the student to think?

I want a university student to feel thought of, because they live in an economy that doesn't consider them here in Rwanda they are basically treated like any other that works for a living yet with high unemployment rate in Rwanda they fully parents dependents making fair prices is the way forward so that they can as well enjoy products service at an affordable price..... they should think of unipicks as a go to.

Yes. I understand the feeling behind Unipicks much better now.

The important part is **not simply "cheap food."** It's:

"Someone actually thought about me as a student."

You want a student to feel that Unipicks understands their situation and gives them access to products, services, and experiences at prices that make sense for their stage of life.

And then, over time, you want the habit to become:

"If I want something, let me check Unipicks first."

That is what **"go-to"** means.

So I would capture the student experience like this:

Feel: *"I am thought of."*

Believe: *"These offers are actually for people like me."*

Behavior: *"Before I spend money, I check Unipicks."*

Long-term habit: *"Unipicks is my go-to place for student deals and experiences."*

That's a strong product direction because it gives us something deeper to measure than just downloads.

Next question — one only

Now let's switch sides.

Imagine **Mr. Chips** is using Unipicks as a business owner.

What do you want Mr. Chips to feel or think after using Unipicks?

I want Mr. Chips to feel connected connected to student a different market segment, customers that can affect his demand on days that he doesn't have many clients.

Exactly. That gives us the other half of the Unipicks idea.

For the **student**:

"Unipicks thinks about me."

For the **business**:

"Unipicks connects me to a market I can reach when I need more demand."

Mr. Chips shouldn't just see Unipicks as another place to post advertisements. He should see it as a **connection to the student market**.

The business value becomes:

Low-demand period → create student offer → reach students → increase demand → make more sales.

And this is important: the business doesn't necessarily need to lower its normal price for everyone. It can create a **student-specific offer** for a specific time, product, or situation.

That connects directly to your original price-discrimination idea.

So we're starting to see the two-sided product clearly:

Unipicks helps students access affordable experiences while helping businesses reach student demand when and where they need it.

That's much stronger than simply saying *"Unipicks gives students discounts."*

Next question — one only

If Unipicks becomes successful in Rwanda, **what do you want Unipicks to be known for?**

Not what it does technically.

What do you want people to say when they hear **"Unipicks"**?

quality, location and discount %

Exactly. That tells us something important: **"better deal" does not simply mean "cheapest."**

For Unipicks, a better deal could mean:

- **Quality** — Is the product/service actually good?
- **Location** — Is it convenient for the student?
- **Discount %** — How much value are they getting compared with the normal price?

So a student might choose a 10% discount nearby with excellent quality over a 30% discount that is far away or poor quality.

That means Unipicks could eventually help students answer:

"Which deal gives me the best value for my money?"

That's much more interesting than simply sorting by discount percentage.

Next question — one only

For the **first version we are focusing on food**, what do you think is the most important thing a student should see **immediately on a food deal card**?

Imagine they are scrolling through Unipicks on their phone. What must they see before they decide whether to tap it?

like i said it has to be like instagram, views, likes, and comments from fella students because this is what make business focus on quality because they know a feedback affects the business reputation

Yes 😂 — now I understand why you kept bringing up the **Instagram-like experience**.

You don't want Instagram just because it looks nice. You want the **social layer to create accountability**.

The idea is:

Business posts deal → students see it → students interact → students rate/comment → other students see the reputation → business has an incentive to maintain quality.

So views, likes, comments, ratings, and eventually other signals aren't just "features." They create a **feedback loop**.

The loop you're imagining

Business quality → Student experience → Student feedback → Public reputation → Business behavior → Better quality

That is powerful because Unipicks could become more than a discount marketplace.

It could become a place where businesses **earn trust from students**.

And this connects beautifully to your earlier point about knowing the difference between a good deal and a better deal.

A deal could have:

- **Price/discount**
- **Quality/reputation**
- **Distance/location**
- **Views**
- **Likes**
- **Student comments**
- **Ratings**

So instead of Unipicks saying:

"This is a 30% discount, therefore it's good."

The **student community helps determine whether it's actually good**.

That's a much stronger product philosophy.

One important thing

We should be careful with likes and views. We shouldn't add them simply because Instagram has them.

For every social feature, we should eventually ask:

Does this help students make better decisions, help businesses improve, or increase useful engagement?

If yes, keep it. If not, don't add it.

Next question — one only

If students can publicly comment and rate businesses, **what should stop a business from deleting bad feedback or manipulating its reputation?**

In other words: **How should Unipicks make student feedback trustworthy?**

It is simply the ability of the business to communicate to the admin because the business should not delete anything all they do is to read and reply that's it

Yes. That's actually a very clean rule.

Businesses don't control the reputation layer.

Their role is:

- 👁️ **Read** student feedback
- 💬 **Reply** to students
- 📧 **Report/appeal** a problem to Unipicks admin
- ❌ **Cannot delete** student feedback
- ❌ **Cannot hide** negative feedback

The **admin** becomes the neutral party that handles disputes, abuse, fake reviews, or content that breaks the rules.

That creates an important trust principle:

Students control the feedback. Businesses control their response.

Unipicks controls moderation.

And it supports the quality idea you described:

Good business → good student experience → good feedback → stronger reputation → more students → more demand.

While:

Poor quality → poor feedback → visible reputation → pressure to improve.

That's a very interesting part of the Unipicks model.

Next question — one only

Now let's think about the **deal itself**.

Should a business be able to create **any deal it wants**, or should Unipicks have rules for what counts as a **good student deal**?

I have been thinking on that but i want all parties to use the app/platform for free, but i charge a business that needs a verified features that comes with a follow option and everything they post they stay at the top, other business that use the platform for free they stay down, also i thought of using ads between stories even between deals but this something i can implement once i know the app has a good visiting traffic daily

Yes. And this is starting to look like a real **business model**, not just an app monetization idea.

Your thinking is:

Free marketplace

Students: free

Businesses: free

That helps you get both sides onto the platform and reduces the barrier to adoption.

Then businesses can pay for **visibility and stronger presence**, rather than paying simply to exist.

For example, your future paid business features could be:

Verified business

- Verified badge
- Students can follow the business
- Business content gets stronger visibility
- Posts can stay higher in the feed

- Potentially better analytics/tools

And your second revenue stream could eventually be:

Advertising

- Ads between Stories
- Ads between deals
- Possibly targeted advertising to the student market

But, as you said, **not now**.

You first need to prove that students actually come back to Unipicks every day. Advertising before you have meaningful traffic would probably hurt the experience more than it helps.

I would capture the principle as:

Build the audience first. Monetize attention later.

There is also an interesting connection to your original idea:

Students get free access → businesses get free access → activity creates a student marketplace → businesses compete for student attention → businesses pay for additional visibility → Unipicks earns revenue without putting the basic student experience behind a paywall.

That's a strong direction.

One thing we'll need to think about later is making sure **paid visibility doesn't destroy trust**. A paid business being higher in the feed shouldn't automatically make its deal look better than an organic deal. We can solve that when we design the ranking system.

Next question — one only

If **two businesses pay for verified/greater visibility**, and both want to be at the top, **how should Unipicks decide which one appears first?**

to be honest i questioned that and i came to a conclusion that all student should not see a single but different paying business to different students that opens the app, do you have a different idea of how it could be done?

Yes. And honestly, I think your conclusion is **stronger** than simply putting all paying businesses at the top.

Your idea is basically:

Unipicks should not show every student the exact same marketplace. It should personalize what each student sees.

That fits your price-discrimination idea very well.

I would consider **3 ways** to do it:

1. Personalized feed — my favorite

Instead of:

Student A sees

1. Mr. Chips
2. Restaurant B
3. Restaurant C

Student B sees the exact same thing

Unipicks could decide:

Student A

- Mr. Chips — because they often buy there

- A cheap lunch deal nearby
- A deal that matches their budget
- A new business they haven't tried

Student B

- Restaurant B — because it is closer
- A different affordable meal
- A deal they have shown interest in
- A new business

So the paid business doesn't simply "buy #1."

It pays for **more chances to be discovered by the right students.**

2. Sponsored discovery

A business could pay Unipicks to promote a deal, but instead of saying:

"This business is #1 for everyone."

Unipicks says internally:

"This business is relevant to these students."

For example, Mr. Chips could pay to reach students who:

- are near the business
- usually buy food around that time
- like similar deals
- have never tried Mr. Chips
- regularly look for cheap meals

That is much more valuable to the business than simply being at the top.

3. A hybrid system — what I would choose

I think Unipicks could eventually have **three types of visibility:**

Organic

"This is genuinely a good/relevant deal for you."

Personalized sponsored

"This business paid to reach students like you."

Trending/social

"Students around you are interacting with this."

And importantly, **paying should never allow a bad deal to completely overpower a good one.**

For example:

Business A pays a lot but has terrible ratings.

Business B doesn't pay but students love it.

Business A can get **extra exposure**, but Business B can still naturally rise because students actually like it.

That protects the trust you want Unipicks to have.

And this gives you a much more interesting answer to the question:

"If two businesses pay, who comes first?"

You don't necessarily need one universal ranking.

There is no single "top."

The feed can be different for every student.

That is actually closer to how social platforms work: the system decides what is relevant to *this particular person*, rather than showing everybody the same thing.

And it connects beautifully with your original idea:

Different students can receive different offers from different businesses.

But I would add one important rule:

Don't personalize only based on what the student will buy. Personalize based on what creates value for both sides.

Student value + business value + Unipicks trust.

So before we decide the exact algorithm, I want to ask you **one question**:

Should a student know that the deal they are seeing was specifically selected for them, or should it feel like Unipicks is simply showing them the best deals available?

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i like this indeed, i always have a philosophy that tells me it never about the money that one can work better

Show more

Exactly. And I think that philosophy can become **one of the core principles of Unipicks.**

Money can buy **more opportunity to be seen**, but it should not buy **trust** or guarantee that a business is better.

That creates a very interesting system:

Pay for exposure. Earn your reputation.

A business can pay to introduce itself to students, but after that, students decide what happens through views, likes, purchases, ratings, comments, and repeat visits.

So over time:

Money → Exposure → Student experience → Feedback → Reputation →

Organic growth

And this is where your philosophy becomes powerful: **the business that works better can eventually outperform the business that simply pays more.**

I would write this into the blueprint as a principle:

Unipicks Principle: Money can buy visibility, but performance earns trust.

That is much stronger than simply saying "paid businesses appear at the top."

Now, one question:

When a student opens Unipicks, what should be the first thing they see: a personalized feed of deals, or a more Instagram-like feed of business posts/stories where deals are mixed naturally into the content?

Students should not see how many purchases thou because the competition is not a thing Rwandans value they could even say it is fake

Yes. That is an important distinction.

Purchases can be useful data for Unipicks, but they don't need to be public data for students.

I would separate **internal analytics** from **public social proof**.

What Unipicks sees internally

Unipicks can use:

- purchases
- views
- clicks
- repeat purchases
- ratings
- comments
- time of day
- day of week
- price
- discount
- location
- deal age

This helps the ranking system make better decisions.

What students see

Students could see things that help them judge the deal without creating a popularity competition:

- 🌟 Student rating
- 💬 Student comments
- 📍 Location
- 💰 Price
- 📄 Discount
- 🕒 When the deal expires
- 🆕 New deal
- 🔥 Popular with students (*only if we can define this carefully*)

But **not**:

"327 students bought this"

or

"Mr. Chips sold 500 meals today."

I agree that could create the wrong feeling, and students might question whether the numbers are real.

The important principle becomes:

Use behavioral data to make Unipicks smarter, not necessarily to show students everything the system knows.

That is actually a very good Business Analytics principle.

And there is another benefit: **businesses don't need to compete publicly against each other on sales numbers either.** They compete by improving their actual offer and student experience.

So our model is becoming:

Businesses → create offers

Students → experience and give feedback

Unipicks → collects data, analyzes it, and improves discovery

That's a much cleaner system.

Next question: For students, do you want **ratings and written comments to be visible to everyone**, or should some feedback remain private between the student and Unipicks?

It should be visible for everyone th

Good. Then we have a clear trust principle for Unipicks:

Student feedback is public. Business sales data is private.

That creates an interesting balance.

Public

Students can see:

- 🌟 Ratings
- 💬 Comments
- Business replies
- Deal price
- Discount
- Location
- Deal availability/expiry

So a student can ask:

"Is this actually a good deal?"

and use other students' experiences to decide.

Private/internal

Unipicks keeps:

- Number of purchases
- Conversion rate
- Views
- Clicks
- Repeat purchases
- Performance by time/day
- Business performance data

Those numbers help the **algorithm and business analytics**, without turning Unipicks into a popularity competition.

And I think this connects strongly to what you said earlier:

Money can buy visibility, but performance earns trust.

A business can pay for exposure, but if students consistently leave poor feedback, that reputation becomes visible.

Likewise, a business that doesn't pay can build a strong reputation through actual student experiences.

One question for the blueprint

If a student leaves a **negative comment**, should the business be allowed to **reply publicly**, but never delete or hide the student's comment?

they can only reply but they can hide as well i think they should also feel like the app is for them as well

Yes — I think that is a better balance.

If Unipicks is supposed to be a **companion for students and a connection to students for businesses**, businesses should also feel that the platform is fair to them.

So I would define it like this:

Student feedback

Student can:

- Leave a rating
- Write a comment
- Edit their own feedback
- Report a problem

Business can:

- Reply publicly
- **Hide a comment from their public business page**
- Report the comment to Unipicks/admin

Business cannot:

- Delete the student's feedback permanently
- Change the student's rating
- Prevent the student from reporting an issue

Unipicks/admin can:

- Review reported content
- Remove content that breaks platform rules
- Handle disputes and abuse

This gives businesses some control over **how their page looks**, while Unipicks still protects the student's voice.

But I would make one important rule:

A business hiding a comment should not make the feedback disappear from Unipicks' records.

That data is valuable for moderation and Business Analytics. If a business is repeatedly hiding legitimate negative feedback, that itself could become a signal.

So we now have another strong principle:

Businesses can manage their space, but they cannot rewrite their reputation.

I like where the blueprint is going. We're not just designing screens anymore — we're defining **how the Unipicks marketplace should behave**.

Next question: When a business hides a student's comment, should the student be notified that the business hid it?

specific reasons they can choose from

Yes. That's much better than giving businesses a simple "**Hide**" button. It makes the system more fair and gives the admin useful data.

Feedback moderation rule

A business can hide a comment **only by selecting a reason**, for example:

- Spam
- Abusive/offensive language
- False or misleading information
- Unrelated to the business/deal
- Personal information
- Duplicate comment
- Other → explain why

The comment disappears from the public page and **doesn't affect the public rating**, but Unipicks keeps it for admin review.

The admin can then see:

Business: Mr. Chips

Action: Comment hidden

Reason: False or misleading information

Comment: [hidden from students]

Date: ...

This is becoming a proper marketplace governance system rather than just a social feature.

And there is an important analytics opportunity here: **Unipicks can learn which businesses frequently hide feedback and why**. That can help identify businesses that are protecting their reputation responsibly versus businesses that may be abusing the feature.

Next question

Should **students also be able to report comments from other students** if they believe a comment is spam, abusive, fake, etc.?

sure why not they need to feel at home on the app

Exactly. That's the feeling we want: **students should feel that Unipicks belongs to them too**, not like they are just customers using a business platform.

So now the community system has three levels:



Students

They can:

- Post ratings and comments
- Edit their own feedback
- Report another student's comment
- Report a business/deal
- See public feedback and business replies



Businesses

They can:

- Reply to comments
- Hide comments **only with a specific reason**
- Report comments
- Manage their business profile and deals



Unipicks Admin

Admin can:

- Review reports
- Review hidden comments
- Remove content when necessary
- Watch for abuse from either students or businesses
- Protect the trust of the platform

And I think there's a bigger principle emerging:

Unipicks is a shared space, not a business advertising board.

Students should feel at home. Businesses should feel welcome. **Unipicks protects the relationship between them.**

That is a strong foundation for your "University Student Companion" idea.

Next question

When students report a comment, should the comment **stay visible while the admin reviews it**, or should it temporarily disappear until the admin makes a decision?

the admin should be flagged but it stays

Yes. I think that's the better approach.

The rule becomes:

A report creates a flag for the admin; it does not automatically remove the content.

That protects against people abusing the reporting system simply because they disagree with someone's opinion.

Our moderation system now

Student reports comment

- Comment stays visible
- Admin receives a flag
- Admin reviews it
- Admin decides whether action is needed

Business hides comment

- Comment disappears publicly

- Business must give a reason
- Admin is notified
- Hidden comment does not affect public rating

This gives Unipicks a nice balance:

Freedom to speak + responsibility to moderate.

And I especially like that you're thinking about how the different sides **feel** when using the platform. That's important product thinking.

Next question

Let's move back to the **Smart Discovery Feed**.

You mentioned that the system should consider **day, time, price, and when the deal was posted**.

What do you think should matter most when Unipicks decides which deal to show a student first?

Day time

Exactly. **Day and time should be the strongest signals.**

That makes the feed more useful because Unipicks is answering:

"What is useful to this student right now?"

For example:

Monday, 7:30 AM

Breakfast / morning offers could have higher priority.

Tuesday, 12:30 PM

Lunch deals become much more relevant.

Friday, 6:00 PM

Food, entertainment, events, or evening activities could become more relevant.

Sunday, 3:00 PM

The system may behave differently because student activity patterns change.

And importantly, the algorithm doesn't need to guess everything from the beginning. **It can learn from actual Unipicks data over time.**

That gives us a very good Business Analytics foundation:

Day + Time → Context → Deal relevance → Ranking → Student action →

Data → Better ranking

Next question

Between **price** and **discount percentage**, which one should matter more when Unipicks decides whether a deal is a good deal for a student?

the price

Yes. That gives us another clear rule:

The actual student price matters more than the advertised discount percentage.

For example:

- Deal A: ~~5,000 RWF~~ → **4,000 RWF** (20% off)
- Deal B: ~~8,000 RWF~~ → **5,000 RWF** (37.5% off)

Even though Deal B has the bigger discount, a student may prefer Deal A

because it costs less.

So Unipicks should not tell students:

"37.5% = better deal."

Instead, it can use **price as a major ranking signal**, while still considering quality, location, discount, day, and time.

We're slowly defining an actual **deal-ranking model**, which is exactly the kind of thinking I want you to practice as a Business Analytics student.

Next question

Should **location** be a major factor too?

For example, if two meals cost the same, should Unipicks prefer the one **closer to the student**?

Yes indeed I wanted to add a feature for students when they get open the app/platform before they get to deals it first asks them if they are on campus or off campus

Yes — **that fits the model very well**. And I think it is better than trying to use precise GPS automatically.

The first question could be very simple:

Where are you today?



On Campus



Off Campus

Then Unipicks uses that as **context**, not as a permanent profile setting.

For example:

On Campus

- Prioritize deals around the campus.
- Consider what students usually want at that time.
- Lunch deals around lunchtime become highly relevant.
- Deals that require going far away rank lower.

Off Campus

- Show deals around the student's current chosen area.
- Give more weight to location and travel distance.
- Potentially include businesses outside the campus ecosystem.

And I especially like **"Where are you today?"** rather than **"Where do you live?"**

Because a student can be:

Monday → On campus

Tuesday → Off campus

Weekend → Somewhere else

So the information stays useful without forcing the student to constantly change their profile.

This gives us a stronger ranking foundation

Context

→ Day

→ Time

→ On/Off campus

→ Location

Deal value

- Actual price
- Discount
- Quality
- Availability/expiry

Freshness

- When posted

Trust

- Student ratings/comments

Business visibility

- Sponsored exposure, within limits

Then Unipicks can calculate which deals deserve attention **right now**.

And there is a nice product detail we should think about later: **don't make the student answer "On campus / Off campus" every single time they open the app**. We could remember their last choice and let them change it easily.

Next question

When a student chooses "**Off Campus**," should Unipicks ask them to **choose their area manually** (for example, a neighborhood/area), or should it use their phone's location if they allow location access?

It would be nice at the checkout when they are ordering only no any other time

Yes — I think that's cleaner.

So **Unipicks should not ask for location when the student opens the app**.

We only need location when it becomes useful: **at checkout/order time**.

That keeps the experience simple.

The flow could be:

Open Unipicks

- See Smart Discovery Feed
- Browse deals
- Choose a deal
- **Checkout**
- Unipicks asks:

Where are you ordering from?



On Campus



Off Campus

If **On Campus**, the system can use the campus/location linked to the student.

If **Off Campus**, then we can ask for the location needed for that order.

This is also better for privacy because we're not constantly asking where the student is.

And from a Business Analytics point of view, the location becomes **transaction context** rather than unnecessary personal data.

So we now have:

Day + Time + Price + Location + Deal freshness + Quality + Engagement → Deal ranking

Next question

For the **Smart Discovery Feed**, should a deal that is **about to expire today** get

a higher ranking because students need to know about it before they miss it?

yeahh... indeed that is good way to let businesses know they are valued

Exactly. And that gives us another important idea: **Unipicks should not only optimize for students; it should also help businesses get value from the platform.**

If a business has a deal expiring today, Unipicks can give it more visibility because there is a real reason:

"This offer has limited time left."

That helps the student discover an opportunity **and** helps the business get the most out of the offer they created.

So the ranking system is becoming more balanced:

Student value

- Affordable price
- Relevant time/day
- Location
- Quality
- Freshness
- Expiry

Business value

- Give new deals a chance
- Help expiring deals get attention
- Help businesses reach students during relevant periods
- Reward businesses that provide good student experiences

Unipicks

- Connects the two using data.

And I really like the philosophy you just mentioned:

A business should feel valued because Unipicks helps its offer reach the right students—not simply because it paid Unipicks.

That could become another product principle.

Next question

If a deal is **very cheap but has consistently poor student ratings**, should Unipicks still rank it highly because of the price, or should poor quality push it down?

Yes good history is good for unipicks

Exactly. That gives Unipicks a **trust system**, not just a ranking system.

A business that consistently gives students a good experience should gradually earn more trust from the platform.

For example:

Good history

- Good student ratings
- Few valid complaints

- Deals match what was advertised
- Students successfully redeem orders
- Business responds professionally
- Doesn't abuse comment hiding/reporting

→ **Higher trust score**

That trust can help a new deal get more visibility.

And importantly, **the business doesn't buy this trust.**

A business can pay for sponsored exposure, but it cannot simply pay its way into a high trust score.

So we now have a very strong principle:

Money can buy exposure. Good performance earns trust.

That is starting to sound like the heart of Unipicks.

And there is another interesting Business Analytics idea here: **trust should be dynamic.** A business shouldn't become permanently "trusted" because it was good six months ago. Recent performance should matter more than very old performance.

Next question

Should a business's **recent performance matter more than its old performance** when Unipicks calculates its trust score?

Yeah the app/platform should consider progress it is part of business growth

Exactly. **Progress matters.** A business should not be trapped forever by its past.

A business that was struggling six months ago but is now improving should be able to **earn its way back up.**

So instead of a simple "good/bad" reputation, Unipicks could think in terms of **business growth:**

Past performance + recent performance + direction of improvement

For example:

Business A

- Old rating: 2.8
- Recent rating: 4.3
- Complaints decreasing
- Better responses to students

→ **Positive growth signal**

Business B

- Old rating: 4.5
- Recent rating: 3.1
- Complaints increasing

→ **Negative trend**

That is much more interesting than just giving businesses a permanent score.

It also fits your original vision of helping businesses **maximize their opportunities.** Unipicks isn't only saying:

"You're good."

It can help create an environment where businesses can **improve and grow.**

So another principle is emerging:

Unipicks rewards progress, not perfection.

And this is where your Business Analytics background can become part of the product itself: you're not just collecting numbers; you're using them to understand **direction and change**.

Next question

Should students be able to see **some indication that a business is improving**, or should the growth analysis stay behind the scenes and only affect the feed?

a student should not be a direct agent.....

how many questions are we remaining with so that we move to building, i have we are going to document all the questions we asked to have a better understanding of the business blueprint

Yes — and I agree with your point.

The **student should not be a direct agent in the business-growth system**.

Students provide natural feedback through their normal use of Unipicks. They shouldn't feel like they are working for the platform by judging or monitoring businesses.

And **yes, we should document all these questions and answers**. That is actually one of the best things we can do before building, because we're turning your ideas into clear product rules instead of coding based on assumptions.

How many questions are left?

I would say roughly **10–15 important questions**.

We've already answered a lot of the difficult ones:

- What Unipicks is
- Who it serves
- Student value
- Business value
- Student companion positioning
- Food-first strategy
- Price as a major value signal
- Day/time as major ranking signals
- Location at checkout
- Smart Discovery Feed
- Sponsored visibility
- Public feedback
- Business replies
- Comment hiding
- Reporting
- Admin moderation
- Deal quality problems
- Business trust
- Business progress
- How student/business relationships should work

What's left is mainly the **operational blueprint**, such as:

1. What exactly makes a deal appear in the feed?
2. How should sponsored deals work?
3. How should the student follow businesses?
4. What should businesses actually be able to post?
5. What happens when a deal expires?
6. How should orders/redemptions work?
7. What happens when something goes wrong with an order?
8. What should the admin be responsible for?
9. What data should Unipicks collect and why?
10. What are the most important success metrics?
11. What is free vs paid for businesses?
12. What is the first version we actually launch?

Then we **stop asking questions and build**.

And I suggest we do something important before building

We'll create a proper:

`docs/02-business-blueprint.md`

It will contain the decisions we've made, not just random notes.

Something like:

Unipicks Business Blueprint

1. Vision

University Student Companion

2. Student Problem

Students need affordable products/services and better ways to discover value.

3. Business Problem

Businesses need access to the student market and better demand during low-demand periods.

4. Marketplace Principles

Money can buy exposure. Performance earns trust.

Progress matters.

Students provide feedback naturally; they are not agents of the platform.

5. Discovery System

Day + Time + Price + Location + Freshness + Quality + Trust + other signals.

6. Social/Community System

Public student feedback, business replies, reporting, moderation.

7. Business Growth System

Internal analytics and trust signals.

8. Monetization

...

9. Core User Journeys

...

10. Analytics

...

11. MVP

...

Then when we start coding, **the blueprint becomes our reference**.

And this is important: **we won't document only what sounds good**. If we later discover that an idea doesn't work, we update the blueprint and record why.

So yes — we're getting close.

Let's finish the remaining important questions, document everything, then move into building.

exactly



Waiting for confirmation

and then:



Confirmed — Pay now

Perfect. That gives us a very clear transaction journey.

Unipicks order states

1. Waiting for confirmation

Student has requested the order.

Business has not accepted yet.

2. Confirmed — Pay now

Business confirmed availability.

Student can safely make the payment.

3. Payment processing

Unipicks is processing the payment.

4. Paid — Show QR/code

Payment succeeded.

Student receives the redemption code/QR.

5. Redeemed

Business verifies the code and gives the student the product/service.

And if something goes wrong, we can have states such as:



Declined

Business cannot fulfill the order.



Expired

Business didn't respond within the allowed time.

This is much cleaner than making the student pay immediately.

It also gives us good data later:

Order requested → confirmation rate → payment rate → redemption rate

But again, these metrics can remain **internal**. Students don't need to see them.

Next question

What should happen if a business **doesn't respond** to an order?

Should Unipicks automatically cancel it after a certain amount of time, for example **10 or 15 minutes**, so the student isn't left waiting?

a student should be able to contact them via phone call.

Yes. I like that because sometimes the fastest solution is simply **calling the business**.

So if an order stays at:

🟡 **Waiting for confirmation**

the student can have:

📞 **Call business**

This is especially useful in the early version of Unipicks because businesses may not always be watching the app.

I would still keep a **time limit** in the system, though. A phone call should be an option, not something that leaves an order permanently open.

For example:

Student orders

- Waiting for confirmation
- Student can call business
- Business confirms in app
- Student pays

If nothing happens after the allowed period:

Order expired — no confirmation received

That protects the student from waiting forever.

One more thing

The business should also have a simple way to:

Accept

Decline

We don't want businesses forced to respond through a chat before they can manage an order.

Next question

If the business **declines** an order, should they be required to select a reason, such as:

- Item unavailable
- Too busy
- Business closed
- Price changed
- Other

or should they simply be able to press **Decline**?

Next question

If the business **declines** an order, should they be required to select a reason, such as:

- Item unavailable
- Too busy
- Business closed
- Price changed
- Other

a clarification is better than a simple decline

Yes — **clarification is better than a cold "Declined."**

The business could select a reason **and optionally add a short explanation.**

For example:

❌ Order can't be fulfilled

Item unavailable right now. Sorry for the inconvenience.

Or:

❌ Order can't be fulfilled

We're currently too busy. Please try again in 30 minutes.

That feels more human and keeps the relationship between the student and business positive.

It also gives Unipicks useful internal data. If a business repeatedly declines because of "**item unavailable**," that tells us something about its inventory or deal design.

So the system becomes:

Student orders → Business reviews → Accept OR Can't fulfill → Reason/clarification → Student understands what happened.

Good. We're getting close to the end of the transaction questions.

Next question

After a student successfully redeems an order, should Unipicks automatically ask them to **rate the experience**, or should rating be optional?

same importance quality without trust means nothing to me

That is a strong principle. **Deal quality and service quality should have equal weight.**

Your point is important:

Quality without trust means nothing.

So Unipicks should not allow a business to rank highly just because it has a good deal if students consistently have a poor experience, and vice versa.

For the internal quality signal:

50% Deal Quality + 50% Service Quality

Then other signals such as recent performance, complaints, and business history can help determine **trust/progress**, without replacing the two core quality ratings.

Next question

Should **ratings from a student who has actually completed an order** count more than ratings from someone who has only viewed or interacted with a deal?

completed the order

Yes. **Only students who completed the order should be able to rate.**

That makes the rating much more trustworthy because the student actually experienced the deal and service.

So the rule is:

No completed order → no rating.

A student who only views, likes, or comments on a deal cannot give the official deal/service rating.

Next question

After a student completes an order, should they be able to **rate the deal and**

service separately, or should Unipicks ask for both ratings in one simple screen?

one simple screen

Perfect. One simple screen is better for the student.

After redemption, Unipicks can show:

How was your experience?

Deal



Service



Skip for now

The student submits both together, or skips the whole rating. No editing later.

This gives us a clean rule: **one completed order → one optional rating screen → two separate ratings.**

Next question

Should the student be able to **rate only after the order is redeemed**, or immediately after payment?

after receiving the payment

Yes — **after the student receives the product/service**, not just after payment.

That gives us a better trust rule:

Order → Business confirms → Student pays → QR/code → Business redeems → Student receives the order → Optional rating

This means the student has actually experienced both the **deal** and the **service** before rating.

Next question

Should Unipicks automatically show the rating screen **once after redemption**, or should it remind the student

yes, even the business as well

Exactly. **Everyone should see that a comment was edited**, including the business.

So an edited comment could show:

"The food was good but took a long time. **Edited**"

This keeps the system transparent. Nobody should wonder whether a comment was changed after a business replied to it.

Next question

Should the **original version of an edited comment** be visible to students and businesses, or should only **Unipicks admins** be able to see the edit history?

only to the admin

Good. That gives us a strong balance between **user control and moderation**.

Comment edit rule

- Student can edit their own comment.
- Everyone sees **"Edited."**
- Students and businesses see only the **latest version**.
- **Admins can see the full edit history**, including the original version.
- This helps admins investigate abuse or manipulation if a problem is reported.

Next question

If a student deletes a comment, should it be **completely removed for everyone**, or should Unipicks keep a record that the comment was deleted for admins?

we keep a record we can't lose data i am studying to keep data



Exactly. **We don't throw away useful data.**

The student should see the comment disappear, but Unipicks should keep the record internally.

Comment deletion rule

- Student can delete their own comment.
- Comment disappears from the public view.
- Admin retains the deleted version and deletion history.
- Business and other students cannot see the deleted content.
- The data can support moderation, fraud detection, and future analysis.
- We should keep an audit trail rather than permanently destroying the record.

And I like your principle here:

If data can help us understand what happened, don't casually destroy it.

Next question

Should deleted comments still **count in Unipicks' internal data/analytics**, or should deletion remove them from all rating and quality calculations?

it should not but it has to mention that on the admin side

Exactly. **Deleted comments should not affect public ratings or quality calculations**, but the admin must know they existed.

So:

-  Deleted comment → excluded from ratings/quality calculations.
-  Students/business → cannot see it.
-  Admin → can see the deleted record and why/when it was deleted.
-  Analytics → can track deletion activity separately, without treating the deleted comment as active feedback.

That gives us clean business metrics while preserving the historical data for moderation and analysis.

Next question

Should the **student be able to report a business**, in addition to reporting individual comments?

not necessary

Agreed. **No automatic notification is necessary.**

The report can stay confidential while Admin investigates. This helps prevent arguments, retaliation, or people trying to influence the investigation.

Reporting principle

Report → Admin reviews → Admin decides → appropriate action

The reported person only needs to be contacted if Admin decides that their side of the story is needed or action is being taken.

Next question

If Admin confirms that a business seriously violated Unipicks rules, should Admin be able to **temporarily suspend the business, permanently remove it, or both depending on the seriousness?**

both depending on the issue

Exactly. **Both, depending on the issue.**

We can make moderation proportional:

-  **Warning** — minor issue, business gets a chance to correct it.
-  **Temporary suspension** — serious or repeated issue.
-  **Permanent removal** — severe violations, fraud, or continued serious abuse.
-  **Reinstatement** — a suspended business can return after meeting the requirements.

And importantly, **removing one deal is not the same as removing the business.** A business can make a bad deal and still be a good business.

Next question

If a business is temporarily suspended, should students who previously interacted with that business still be able to **see their old orders, receipts, ratings, and comments?**

no every thing about the business disappears

Understood. **From the student side, the business should disappear completely when suspended.**

That means students should no longer see:

- The business profile
- Its deals
- Its posts/stories
- Its comments
- Its ratings

- Its presence in search/discovery

However, because you said **"we can't lose data,"** Unipicks should still keep the business's records securely on the **admin side** for history, investigations, and analytics. They simply become invisible to students.

Next question

When a suspended business is later allowed to return, should its **old reputation and history come back**, or should it return with a fresh start?

fresh start

Yes. **Fresh start** makes sense.

When a suspended business is allowed back:

- It returns with a new public reputation.
- Old ratings don't affect its new public score.
- Old comments don't appear publicly.
- Old deals/posts don't return automatically.
- Its previous history remains available **only to Admin**.
- The business has to rebuild student trust through new performance.

This fits your principle that **progress matters**: a business can make mistakes, improve, and come back—but it has to earn trust again.

Next question

Should a **permanently removed business** ever be allowed to create another Unipicks business account, or should the removal be permanent?

it should be permanent

Agreed. **Permanent removal means permanent removal.**

A permanently removed business should not be able to simply create another account and return.

Unipicks should keep an internal record so Admin can identify attempts to come back through the same business or related information.

That gives us a clear moderation ladder:

Warning → Temporary suspension → Possible return with fresh reputation → Permanent removal

Next question

Should a business that is **temporarily suspended** still be able to log in and communicate with Unipicks Admin, or should it be completely locked out?

five min max

Good. **Payment also has a 5-minute maximum.**

So the complete timing system is becoming very simple:

Stage	Maximum time
Business to confirm/decline	5 min

Student cancellation window	5 min
Student to pay after confirmation	5 min

If the student doesn't pay within those 5 minutes:

Confirmed → Payment expired → Order cancelled

No payment means no QR/code is generated.

Next question

Once the student pays successfully, should the **QR/code expire after a certain time**, or should it remain valid until the student redeems the order or the deal itself expires?

what do you think i should do?

I would use **both an order-level expiry and a deal-level expiry**, rather than leaving the QR/code valid forever.

My recommendation:

- **QR/code is valid until the deal/order's stated expiry time.**
- If the business has a specific pickup/service time, the code can also expire after that window.
- Once expired, it cannot be redeemed.
- The student should clearly see the expiry time/countdown.
- If the student paid but the business cannot fulfill the order before expiry, Unipicks should handle the cancellation/refund according to the order rules.

Why I prefer this: **a paid QR code that stays valid forever creates problems.**

The business may change prices, stop selling the product, close, or leave Unipicks. An expiry gives both sides a clear deadline.

I would **not** use a short 5-minute expiry for the QR itself. The 5-minute rule is good for **confirmation and payment**, but the redemption window should depend on the actual deal.

Next question

Should a business be required to set an **expected pickup/fulfillment time** when it confirms the order, so the student knows when their order should be ready?

okay use both then

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Show more

Perfect. We will use **both**.

Redemption expiry

Order-level expiry

- The business can provide an expected pickup/fulfillment window.
- The QR/code is valid until that order window ends.

Deal-level expiry

- The QR/code can never remain valid beyond the deal's expiry time.
- Whichever deadline comes first wins.

The student will clearly see something like:

Ready for pickup

QR valid until **6:30 PM**

Deal expires **7:00 PM**

So the **6:30 PM order deadline wins**.

This keeps the payment and redemption system predictable.

Next question

When a business confirms an order, should it be required to give the student an **estimated ready time** (for example, "Ready in 15 minutes")?

no need they should tell the student that they will call when the order is done

yes unipicks is for students basically it should learn and meet their demand, the admin should be flagged in fact

Exactly. That is becoming one of the **most important Business Analytics parts of Unipicks**.

Demand intelligence

If students search for something and Unipicks cannot satisfy that demand, we should record it.

For example:

50 students search for **pizza**

→ only 2 relevant deals exist

→ **Demand gap detected**

→ Admin gets a flag

→ Admin can look for businesses that could serve that demand.

The same can happen with:

- Search with no results
- Searches with very few results

- Frequently viewed but unavailable products
- Deals students repeatedly search for
- High demand in a location with few businesses
- Demand at specific times/days

This turns Unipicks into more than a marketplace.

Students generate demand → Unipicks learns the demand → businesses get an opportunity → students get better options.

And this fits your original Mr. Chips story very well: instead of asking a business to guess “**How do I get Kepler students?**”, Unipicks can eventually show where student demand actually exists.

Next question — Business onboarding

When a business wants to join Unipicks, what should be **required before Admin approves them?**

For example:

- Business name
- Phone number
- Location/address
- Business registration information
- Business category
- Owner identity
- Photos
- Menu/products

What do you think should be required?

Next question — Business onboarding

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For example:

- Business name
- Phone number
- Location/address
- Business registration information
- Business category
- Owner identity
- Photos
- Menu/products

What do you think should be required?

Business name, phone number, momopay code, location address, business registration information, business category, Logo, menu products, (optional Owner ID) all this the admin should be able to view them

Show more

Perfect. That gives us a clear **business verification standard.**

Business onboarding

Required

- Business name

- Phone number
- MoMo Pay code
- Location/address
- Business registration information
- Business category
- Business logo
- Menu/products

Optional

- Owner ID

Admin access

Admin should be able to view all submitted business information and use it during approval, investigation, and future verification.

This is important because Unipicks is not just letting anyone post a deal.

Businesses are entering a trusted student marketplace.

Next question — Business posts

You said businesses should have freedom to express themselves and eventually post **Deals + Updates + Events**.

For the first food version, should a business be able to post a **normal update that is not a deal** (for example, "We have a new burger today"), or should every post initially need to contain an offer/deal?

it should be we have a new burger for students buy 1 get 2 bring your friends, offer/deals is a must

Yes. That's a strong rule for the MVP:

Every business post must give the student a clear offer or deal.

So instead of:

❌ "We have a new burger."

It becomes:

✅ **"New Student Burger 🍔 — Buy 1, Get 2. Bring your friends!"**

This keeps Unipicks focused on its first promise: **help students find better value.**

Businesses can still be creative with the offer:

- Buy 1, get 1
- Student bundle
- Discounted price
- Group deal
- Free add-on
- Limited-time offer
- Happy-hour/student-hour deal

Later, when we introduce **Updates and Events**, we can decide whether those must also contain a student benefit.

Next question — Business dashboard

When a business opens Unipicks, what are the **3 most important things** you want them to see first?

For example:

1. **Orders waiting for action**
2. **Today's sales**
3. **Deal performance**

What would you choose?

1. **Orders waiting for action**
2. Deal performance

mutual friendships consent is a must

Absolutely. **Mutual friendship + consent** fits Unipicks well.

So the rule becomes:

Student A sends a friend request → Student B accepts → they become Unipicks friends.

Until accepted:

- No friendship is created.
- The requester cannot treat the person as a friend.
- Friendship-based recommendations should not use the connection.
- Either student can remove the friendship later.
- Blocking/reporting should be available for safety.

This also gives us a good principle for the social side of Unipicks:

Unipicks can learn from behavior, but it never creates personal relationships without consent.

And the friendship system can later support group ordering, sharing deals, events, and other student experiences.

Next question

When a student starts a group order, **who should be able to join it?**

A. Only their Unipicks friends

B. Anyone with the group-order link/code

C. Both — friends can join directly, and the student can share a link/code with anyone they choose

A. Anyone with the group-order link/code student move in groups mostly paired, but when they hang there are more than 2, they can reach to 5 even more during break time or lunch time

Yes — that makes sense. I misunderstood your choice in the previous question. You want **anyone who receives the group-order link/code to be able to join**, not only friends.

That fits real student behavior:

-  Two friends might start an order.
-  At lunch, 4–5 classmates may join.
-  During breaks, the group could become even larger.
- The group does **not** need to already exist as a friendship network.
- Each student still pays independently unless they choose to buy for

someone else.

So we have an important distinction:

Friends = personal social relationship.

Group order = temporary shared activity.

That is actually very good product design because students shouldn't need to become friends on Unipicks just to order food together.

Next question

Should a group order have a **maximum number of students**, or should the business decide the maximum when creating the group deal?

No it should not, but the business can make that decision, plus there are more benefits delivery gets cheaper

Exactly. So the **default is no hard maximum**, but the business can set one when it makes sense.

And we now have another important benefit of Group Orders:

Group Orders create value on both sides

For students

- Everyone can pay for themselves.
- One student can optionally buy for others.
- More people can unlock a better deal.
- Shared delivery can become cheaper.
- It is easy to invite people with a link/code.
- It works naturally for lunch, breaks, and hanging out.

For businesses

- One group can bring many customers.
- They can set minimum/maximum group sizes.
- They can create special group-only offers.
- Delivery becomes more efficient when several orders go together.
- It can increase sales during slow periods.

So Group Orders may become one of the strongest **student-network effects** in Unipicks.

And I like the distinction we have reached:

Friendship connects people. Group Orders bring people together around an activity.

Next question

For delivery savings, should Unipicks show the students the saving **before they join the group?**

For example:



Normal delivery: **1,500 RWF**



If 5 students join: **700 RWF each**

You save 800 RWF

Yes or No?

Yes, in fact it speaks for its self

A must have university app every high school graduate in Rwanda is owed to know and have

Yes. That is the **big vision**.

Not:

"Unipicks is a food-deal app."

But:

"Unipicks is a must-have university companion that every high-school graduate in Rwanda knows about and wants to have."

That gives us a much stronger north star.

The Unipicks journey

High-school graduate → University → Student Unipicks → Professional Unipicks → Next life stage

And the reason someone keeps Unipicks is not one feature. It is because the platform keeps becoming useful as their life changes.

For the student, it starts with:

Save money → discover better deals → order with friends → discover university experiences → build connections.

For businesses:

Reach students → fill demand → sell more → build reputation → understand student demand.

And eventually, Unipicks can become a **major student-market infrastructure in Rwanda**, not simply another app.

I think we now have enough of the **vision and product identity** to make the next questions more focused.

Next question

If Unipicks becomes this important to university students in Rwanda, **what should be Unipicks' biggest advantage over a normal delivery app like Vuba Vuba?**

What should make a student say:

"I could use Vuba Vuba, but I prefer Unipicks because ____."

Unipicks helps business good decision on what to produce for the market well as vuba vuba it serves all but, unipicks is picky and i a picky as a person



That actually fits the name **Unipicks** very well.

You are not trying to be the platform that has **everything for everyone**.

You want Unipicks to be **picky** — selective about what is shown to students and useful to businesses.

So the difference becomes:

Vuba Vuba serves the general market. Unipicks understands and serves the university market.

But there is an even deeper advantage in what you said:

Unipicks doesn't just distribute demand — it learns from demand.

For example:

Students search:

"Pizza" 🍕

Unipicks sees:

- 300 searches
- mostly around lunchtime
- mostly around campus
- few good pizza deals available

That becomes business intelligence:

"There is student demand for pizza here, at this time, but the current supply is weak."

A business can then make a better decision about **what to produce, when to produce it, where to sell it, and what price/offer to use.**

That's much closer to your Business Analytics background:

Student behavior → Data → Information → Insight → Business decision

And your "picky" personality can actually become a product philosophy:

Unipicks is picky about what students see because students deserve better choices, and picky about what businesses offer because the platform learns what students actually want.

That could become one of the strongest ideas in the entire blueprint.

Next question

When Unipicks learns that students strongly want something that **no business currently offers**, should Unipicks actively approach businesses and say:

"Students are looking for this. Would you like to serve them?"

Yes or No?

yes that is data that can be sold to business developers

Exactly. **That turns Unipicks into more than a marketplace. It becomes a student-demand intelligence platform.**

The flow could become:

Students search/interact → Unipicks collects demand signals → Unipicks identifies gaps → businesses see opportunities → businesses create offers → students get better choices.

For example:

Demand opportunity: Kepler area



Pizza searches: High



Peak demand: 12:00–14:00



Demand concentration: Near campus



Current suitable offers: Low



Opportunity: Student pizza market

A business developer could use that information to decide whether there is an opportunity worth entering.

But there is an important distinction

We should not sell **individual student data**.

The valuable product is **aggregated demand intelligence**:

- What students want
- Where demand exists

- When demand happens
- Price ranges students respond to
- Categories with insufficient supply
- Trends over time

That protects students while still making the data commercially valuable.

And this gives Unipicks a potential **second business model** later:

Marketplace revenue + Business Intelligence revenue.

The marketplace helps students and businesses transact.

The intelligence layer helps businesses make better decisions.

That is very aligned with your Business Analytics path.

Next question

If a business pays Unipicks for this demand intelligence, should **students benefit from that value too?**

For example, some of the revenue could help Unipicks negotiate **even better student prices and offers.**

that is the point if the business works the student should benefit yes indeed, i think we should move to production because talking wont make the app please